

get the different files we need – legally and illegally (the latter, which you know we condemn). The protocol that actually enables people to share files with each other, using torrent files, is BitTorrent. Founded by Bram Cohen, BitTorrent is a network used to distribute large amounts of data over the internet. Peer to peer (P2P) file sharing through the BitTorrent network is responsible for about 3.35% of worldwide bandwidth. More than one-third of the internet traffic, and around 2.5 million people use BitTorrent monthly. BitTorrent clients such as µTorrent and Vuze make it very simple to download the required data using a torrent file. But if you want to elevate your BitTorrent experience, or just want to show off to your friends read on further for some really cool tips and tricks for BitTorrent.

leech ratio. Though, how good a torrent is depends on a lot more than just the number of seeds and peers (availability, average swarm speed etc.). Never pick out torrents with extremely higher number of leeches (peers) than seeds. Arranging the torrents by seeders (from high to low) will usually provide the best clue to what might be a successful torrent.

Change bandwidth settings

This is the basic and usually crucial tip for beginners to speed up their torrent downloads once they've found a healthy torrent. A properly configured client is perhaps the most important factor in deciding your download speed. An appropriate upload speed is very important since if it's set too low, peers might drop you or limit the data they send to you, and if set too high, it will take up too much of your bandwidth. So we suggest setting the 'Maximum upload rate' to around 80% of your max upload speed in KB/s (Speed testing sites such as [decrease the numbers depending on your internet speed. A good yardstick would be as follows. For a 1MB/s connection, these settings should work well:](http://www.speed-</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox=)

- **Global maximum number of connections:** 250
- **Maximum number of connected peers per torrent:** 100
- **Number of upload slots per torrent:** 10

Decrease the speeds and the other numbers, and keep experimenting till you find what works for you. Just make sure that the maximum number of connected peers per torrent doesn't exceed the global maximum number of connections.

Although we used µTorrent as an example here, these settings can be applied universally to all BitTorrent clients. µTorrent also has its own speed-test and setup guide. Just go to options > setup guide and run tests. You can also change it manually in the setup guide by selecting the approximate upload speed in the drop-down given.

Add more trackers

This is a tip that works mighty well with public torrents. To increase the speed, just try adding more trackers. To do this, just get the Hash of the current torrent file (look under the info tab of your torrent), google it and download the same torrent file from a different website. When trying to add the torrent, a pop-up will appear that the torrent is already in the



The µTorrent setup guide

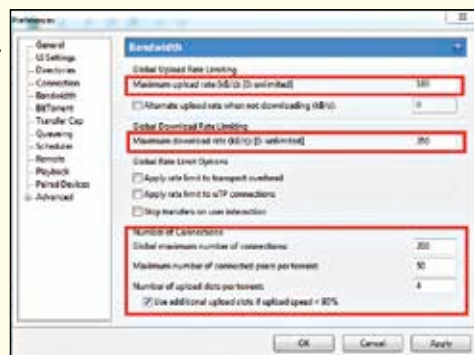
list – just select yes, and Voila! The number of peers will increase, and more importantly, so will the number of seeds. Wait about 4-5 minutes before the increase in speeds actually kicks in. Particularly useful for those annoying times when your torrent gets stuck between 95-99%.

Encrypt your connection

Since BitTorrent accounts for a lot of internet traffic, usually many ISPs tend to throttle the speed upon detecting BitTorrent traffic, and while Seedboxes seem to be a good option to avoid this, they're relatively expensive. So a cheaper, easier method, though less effective, is encryption. Encrypting your outgoing connection will disguise your BitTorrent traffic. To do this, go to Options > Preferences > BitTorrent > select 'Enabled' under Protocol Encryption.

Download torrents using your browser

We almost automatically relate downloading through torrents with BitTorrent clients. Most of us tend to use our browsers only to find the torrent file in question, and then download it through a client. But, there are



Change bandwidth settings to improve speed

Most of the tips given here will be using µTorrent as the client. µTorrent is the client we recommend for your BitTorrenting needs. Light, efficient and loaded with features, this client is a must-have.

Faster torrents

One problem everyone wants to tackle is the speed of their torrent downloads. Here's how to ensure faster downloads.

Use good torrents

This may be an obvious tip, but always download healthy torrent files with a good seed to

test.net usually give speeds in Kb/s. Remember, 1 Byte = 8 bits), and set the 'Maximum download rate' to about 95% of your maximum download speed according to the test. In µTorrent, go to Options > Preferences > Bandwidth > Change the settings.

While there isn't really a magic number involved for the number of connections, this is quite tricky. A high setting will involve usage of too much bandwidth for pinging peers, and a setting too low will result in less number of connections. So we suggest you increase or



Add more trackers